

Aji C. George

Strategic Finance & Internal Audit Leader | Head of Finance | Finance Director | CFO-Track

+971 50 667 5064 ♦ Dubai, United Arab Emirates

ajichekkayilgeorge@gmail.com ♦ [linkedin.com/in/aji-c-george](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aji-c-george) ♦ Portfolio

CPA | CMA | CIA | CCP | CIMA | 24+ Years UAE & GCC | UAE Employment Visa (valid to Oct 2026)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Five-qualified finance leader (CPA, CMA, CIA, CCP, CIMA) with 24+ years in UAE/GCC investment-holding, real estate, construction and manufacturing groups. Lead the group finance function and serve as interim Head of Finance / CFO for subsidiaries above AED 200M turnover, owning IFRS group consolidation across 40+ entities, treasury, P&L and risk-based internal audit. Held group debt-to-asset below 2x and weighted cost of capital below 7.5%, and cut the annual audit close by 10–15 days. Targeting Head of Finance, Finance Director or Internal Audit leadership in the UAE/GCC.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Protected solvency across a multi-billion-dirham, 40+ subsidiary holding – debt-to-asset held below 2x and weighted cost of capital below 7.5% – through bank negotiation and refinancing of high-cost facilities.
- Accelerated the annual group audit close by 10–15 days by re-engineering closing schedules, reconciliations and external-auditor coordination.
- Strengthened working capital by collecting receivables 7–10 days faster and securing 10–15 days of additional vendor credit across the group.
- Cut delivered project costs 8–15% and equipment-rental costs 30% on AED 100M–600M construction programmes (ALEC).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Financial Leadership & Reporting: P&L Management, IFRS Group Consolidation (IFRS 9/15/16), FP&A, Statutory & Management Reporting, Board Reporting, Budgeting & Forecasting, Variance Analysis, Financial Modelling, Capex Planning, DCF.

Treasury & Capital Structure: Treasury & Banking, Liquidity & Cash Management, Bank Facilities, LC & Bank Guarantees, Working Capital, Cash Flow Forecasting, Capital Structure, Cost of Capital, Debt Refinancing, Financial Restructuring.

Audit, Risk & Governance: Risk-Based Internal Audit, Internal Controls, Risk Management, External Audit Coordination, Audit Finalization, Forensic Review, Due Diligence, Governance & Compliance.

Tax, Systems & Specialized Finance: UAE VAT & FTA Filing, UAE Corporate Tax, ERP / System Implementation, Investment Accounting, Intercompany Reconciliation, Related-Party Transactions, Project & Contract Costing, Cost Optimization, Stakeholder Management, M&A / Feasibility.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Group Finance Manager / Interim Head of Finance & CFO

Oct 2008 – Present

Investment Group (Pvt.) Ltd

Sharjah, UAE

- Direct group finance and act as interim Head of Finance / CFO for subsidiaries exceeding AED 200M turnover, leading financial restructuring, capital-injection appraisals, project-return analysis and feasibility studies.
- Deliver consolidated IFRS group accounts and management/board reporting across 40+ subsidiaries – group reporting scope spanning AED 30B+ in revenue and AED 20B+ in assets – across real estate, oil trading & bunkering, insurance, manufacturing and contracting.
- Strengthened capital structure and solvency – debt-to-asset below 2x, bank debt-to-asset below 1.5x, 60:40 equity-to-debt mix and weighted cost of capital below 7.5% – via bank negotiation and refinancing of high-cost facilities.
- Strengthened the control environment across entities and assets up to AED 7B by leading risk-based internal audits and forensic reviews, surfacing control gaps and driving remediation reported to the Group

Managing Director and Group Finance Head.

- Accelerated the annual audit close by 10–15 days year over year by re-engineering closing schedules, strengthening reconciliations and coordinating external auditors with divisional finance teams.
- Improved group liquidity – receivables collected 7–10 days faster and 10–15 days additional vendor credit secured – while managing bank facilities, LCs, guarantees, trust receipts and inventory hedging group-wide.
- Cut related-party transaction processing 30% and VAT-documentation effort 20% through IT-redesigned data entry, reduced high-value overheads 20%, and ensured full UAE VAT and corporate tax (FTA) compliance.

Senior Accountant

Nov 2004 – Sep 2008

Al Jaber Engineering & Contracting LLC (ALEC)

Dubai, UAE

- Reduced project material costs 8–15% versus budget, equipment-rental costs 30% (idle-plant redeployment) and material loss 10% on AED 100M–600M high-rise, mall and hospitality projects for a USD 1B-turnover contractor (12,000+ staff; clients including Majid Al Futtain, Emaar and Aldar).
- Controlled project and contract accounting, WIP and IFRS revenue recognition; designed activity-based costing and integrated Bills of Quantities into the ERP, and built the budgeting and forecasting framework.
- Delivered monthly cost reports with cost/schedule variance analysis, cut idle-labour impact 3–5% through timely labour-hour reporting, and appraised CAPEX using DCF.
- Co-developed an integrated accounting system and strengthened internal controls and segregation of duties to mitigate fraud.

Senior Accountant

Sep 2002 – Jan 2004

Bahrain & Al Jazira Dairies

Manama, Bahrain

- Owned the full finance function for a dairy and beverage manufacturer (40+ products, 50+ staff), finalizing accounts and managing receivables, payables, payroll and bank reconciliations.
- Stood up a finance, inventory and payroll ERP and built product costing and segmented sales reporting that informed pricing and margin decisions.

Senior Branch Accountant

May 1999 – Sep 2002

Fujairah National Construction LLC

UAE

- Finalized branch accounts and project cost accounting across multiple construction jobs – general ledger, project budgets, cost-to-complete and variance analysis.
- Managed progress billing, subcontractor and supplier payments and disputes, receivable collection and bank/balance-sheet reconciliations.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Certified Public Accountant (CPA) – AICPA • Certified Management Accountant (CMA) – IMA
Certified Internal Auditor (CIA) – IIA • Certified Cost Professional (CCP) – AACE International
Advanced Diploma in Management Accounting – CIMA, UK • Master of Commerce (M.Com) – India

UAE CREDENTIALS

Dubai, UAE • UAE Employment Visa valid until Oct 2026 • Valid UAE Driving License •
Nationality: Indian • Languages: English, Hindi, Malayalam